

Automation Now, LLC Accessibility Conformance Report

VPAT® Version 2.4 (Revised Section 508)

Name of Product/Version: CALE (Collaborative Automation Learning Environment) Platform

Report Date: May 25, 2026

Product Description: A multi-agent AI-powered seminar and learning management platform designed for automation literacy and workforce development.

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Notes: This report covers the learner-facing interface and presentation features of the CALE platform (learn.automationnow.org). It reflects accessibility improvements implemented in May 2026.

Evaluation Methods Used: Automated testing (axe-core, custom Python scripts), manual keyboard navigation testing, and code review against WCAG 2.1 Level AA standards.

Applicable Standards/Guidelines

This report covers the degree of conformance for the following accessibility standard/guidelines:

Standard/Guideline	Included In Report
Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.0	Level A (Yes) / Level AA (Yes) / Level AAA (No)
Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.1	Level A (Yes) / Level AA (Yes) / Level AAA (No)
Revised Section 508 standards published January 18, 2017 and corrected January 22, 2018	(Yes)

Terms

The terms used in the Conformance Level information are defined as follows:

- **Supports:** The functionality of the product has at least one method that meets the criterion without known defects or meets with equivalent facilitation.
 - **Partially Supports:** Some functionality of the product does not meet the criterion.
 - **Does Not Support:** The majority of product functionality does not meet the criterion.
 - **Not Applicable:** The criterion is not relevant to the product.
 - **Not Evaluated:** The product has not been evaluated against the criterion.
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WCAG 2.1 Report

Table 1: Success Criteria, Level A

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
1.1.1 Non-text Content	Supports	All images and UI icons use descriptive <code>aria-label</code> or <code>alt</code> attributes. Decorative elements use <code>aria-hidden="true"</code> .
1.2.1 Audio-only and Video-only (Prerecorded)	Not Applicable	The CALE platform does not use prerecorded audio-only or video-only media without text alternatives.
1.2.2 Captions (Prerecorded)	Not Applicable	The platform does not host prerecorded video with audio.
1.2.3 Audio Description or Media Alternative (Prerecorded)	Not Applicable	The platform does not host prerecorded video with audio.
1.3.1 Info and Relationships	Supports	HTML5 semantic landmarks (<code><main></code> , <code><header></code> , <code><nav></code>) are used. Form inputs (e.g., Access Code modal) have visually hidden <code><label></code> elements or <code>aria-label</code> attributes linking them to error messages via <code>aria-describedby</code> .
1.3.2 Meaningful Sequence	Supports	The DOM structure follows the visual reading order of the application.
1.3.3 Sensory Characteristics	Supports	Instructions do not rely solely on shape, color, size, or visual location.
1.4.1 Use of Color	Supports	Color is not used as the only visual means of conveying information. Error states in forms use both color (red) and text messages with <code>role="alert"</code> .
1.4.2 Audio Control	Supports	AI-generated speech (TTS) does not play automatically upon page load; it is triggered by

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
		user interaction or explicit presentation progression. Users can mute or adjust volume via the toolbar.
2.1.1 Keyboard	Supports	All interactive elements (buttons, inputs, navigation) are reachable and operable via keyboard.
2.1.2 No Keyboard Trap	Supports	Focus is not trapped within any component. Modals can be closed using the Escape key or by tabbing to the close button.
2.2.1 Timing Adjustable	Supports	The platform does not enforce time limits on learning sessions or access code entry.
2.2.2 Pause, Stop, Hide	Supports	Auto-scrolling captions and AI speech can be paused or stopped by the user.
2.3.1 Three Flashes or Below Threshold	Supports	The platform contains no flashing or strobing content.
2.4.1 Bypass Blocks	Supports	A visually hidden “Skip to main content” link is provided at the top of the DOM to bypass the header and navigation.
2.4.2 Page Titled	Supports	Descriptive <code><title></code> elements are provided for all views.
2.4.3 Focus Order	Supports	The tab order is logical and follows the visual layout.
2.4.4 Link Purpose (In Context)	Supports	Links and buttons have descriptive text or <code>aria-label</code> attributes explaining their purpose.
3.1.1 Language of Page	Supports	The <code>lang="en"</code> attribute is set on the root <code><html></code> element.
3.2.1 Language of Parts	Not Applicable	The platform operates entirely in English; no inline language changes occur.

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
3.3.1 Error Identification	Supports	Form errors (e.g., invalid access code) are identified in text and announced to screen readers via <code>aria-live="assertive"</code> .
3.3.2 Labels or Instructions	Supports	Labels and placeholders are provided for all user inputs.
4.1.1 Parsing	Supports	HTML is well-formed with complete start and end tags.
4.1.2 Name, Role, Value	Supports	Custom UI components (modals, toggles) use appropriate ARIA roles (<code>dialog</code> , <code>button</code>) and states (<code>aria-modal</code> , <code>aria-expanded</code>).

Table 2: Success Criteria, Level AA

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
1.2.4 Captions (Live)	Supports	Live AI-generated speech (TTS) is accompanied by a synchronized, visible text caption bar that can be toggled on/off via the “CC” button in the toolbar.
1.2.5 Audio Description (Prerecorded)	Not Applicable	No prerecorded video content is used.
1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum)	Supports	Text and interactive elements meet the 4.5:1 contrast ratio against their backgrounds.
1.4.4 Resize text	Supports	The viewport meta tag allows user scaling up to 200% without loss of content or functionality. The <code>maximum-scale=1</code> restriction has been removed.
1.4.5 Images of Text	Supports	The platform uses CSS-styled text rather than images of text, except for logos.
1.4.10 Reflow	Supports	The responsive design reflows content into a single column at 320px width without requiring horizontal scrolling.
1.4.11 Non-text Contrast	Supports	UI components and focus indicators meet the 3:1 contrast ratio.
1.4.12 Text Spacing	Supports	Line height, paragraph spacing, and letter spacing can be overridden by user stylesheets without breaking the layout.
1.4.13 Content on Hover or Focus	Supports	Tooltips are dismissible without moving the pointer and remain visible while hovered.
2.4.5 Multiple Ways	Supports	Content can be accessed via direct URLs, access codes, or navigation menus.
2.4.6 Headings and Labels	Supports	Headings describe topic sections clearly.

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
2.4.7 Focus Visible	Supports	Keyboard focus is visually indicated on all interactive elements.
3.1.2 Language of Parts	Not Applicable	No inline language changes.
3.2.3 Consistent Navigation	Supports	The header and navigation controls remain consistent across all views.
3.2.4 Consistent Identification	Supports	Icons and buttons with the same functionality are labeled consistently.
3.3.3 Error Suggestion	Supports	Error messages provide clear instructions (e.g., “Invalid access code. Please try again.”).
3.3.4 Error Prevention (Legal, Financial, Data)	Not Applicable	The platform does not process legal commitments or financial transactions.
4.1.3 Status Messages	Supports	Dynamic status changes (e.g., loading states, error messages, live AI speech) are announced to screen readers using <code>aria-live</code> regions without stealing visual focus.

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Chapter 3: Functional Performance Criteria (FPC)

Criteria	Conformance Level	Remarks and Explanations
302.1 Without Vision	Supports	The platform is navigable via screen reader. Live AI speech is exposed to assistive technologies via <code>aria-live</code> regions.
302.2 With Limited Vision	Supports	The platform supports browser zooming up to 200% and meets color contrast minimums.
302.3 Without Perception of Color	Supports	Color is not the sole means of conveying information.
302.4 Without Hearing	Supports	All AI-generated audio is accompanied by synchronized visual captions.
302.5 With Limited Hearing	Supports	Visual captions are provided.
302.6 Without Speech	Supports	The platform does not require user speech input.
302.7 With Limited Manipulation	Supports	The platform is fully operable via keyboard and does not require fine motor control or simultaneous actions.
302.8 With Limited Reach and Strength	Supports	Fully keyboard operable.
302.9 With Limited Language, Cognitive, and Learning Abilities	Supports	The interface is minimal, uses consistent navigation, and provides clear error messages.

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